CBSE Class 10 Geography — Chapter 4 Notes

Subject: Social Science (Geography) | **Chapter:** Agriculture | **Target:** Board Exam Revision

India is an **agriculturally important country**. Two-thirds of its population is engaged in agricultural activities. Agriculture is a primary activity, which produces most of the food that we consume. Besides food grains, it also produces raw material for various industries.

1. Types of Farming

A. Primitive Subsistence Farming:

• Practiced on small patches of land with the help of primitive tools like hoe, dao, and digging sticks, and family/community labour.
• It depends upon monsoon, natural fertility of the soil and suitability of other environmental conditions.
• It is a **'slash and burn'** agriculture. Farmers clear a patch of land and produce food crops. When the soil fertility decreases, the farmers shift and clear a fresh patch of land for cultivation.
• **Regional Names:** *Jhumming* (North-Eastern states), *Pamlou* (Manipur), *Dipa* (Bastar, Chhattisgarh), *Milpa* (Mexico), *Roca* (Brazil), *Ladang* (Indonesia).

B. Intensive Subsistence Farming:

• Practiced in areas of **high population pressure** on land.
• It is labour-intensive farming, where high doses of biochemical inputs and irrigation are used for obtaining higher production.
• Landholdings are small and uneconomical due to the right of inheritance leading to division of land.

C. Commercial Farming:

• Uses higher doses of modern inputs, e.g., High Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds, chemical fertilisers, insecticides and pesticides in order to obtain higher productivity.
• **Plantation:** A type of commercial farming where a single crop is grown on a large area. Plantations cover large tracts of land, using capital intensive inputs, with the help of migrant labourers (e.g., Tea in Assam, Coffee in Karnataka).

2. Cropping Pattern

India has three cropping seasons — Rabi, Kharif and Zaid.

Feature	Rabi	Kharif	Zaid
Sowing Period	Winter (October to December)	Onset of monsoon (June-July)	Short season in summer (March to May)
Harvesting Period	Summer (April to June)	September to October	Before the monsoon rains
Important Crops	Wheat, barley, peas, gram, mustard	Paddy, maize, jowar, bajra, tur, moong, urad, cotton, jute, groundnut, soyabean	Watermelon, muskmelon, cucumber, vegetables, fodder crops

Key Regions	Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh	Assam, West Bengal, coastal regions of Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Maharashtra	Most irrigated parts of Northern and Central India

3. Major Crops Grown in India

• **Rice:** Staple food crop for a majority of Indians. India is the second largest producer in the world after China. Requires high temperature (above 25°C), high humidity, and annual rainfall above 100 cm.
• **Wheat:** Second most important cereal crop. Main food crop in north and north-western parts of the country. Requires a cool growing season and a bright sunshine at the time of ripening. Needs 50 to 75 cm of annual rainfall.
• **Millets:** Jowar, Bajra and Ragi are the important millets grown in India. Known as coarse grains, they have very high nutritional value.
• **Sugarcane:** Tropical as well as a subtropical crop. It grows well in hot and humid climates with a temperature of 21°C to 27°C and an annual rainfall between 75cm and 100cm.
• **Fiber Crops:** Cotton, Jute, Hemp and Natural Silk are the four major fiber crops. Cotton requires high temperature, light rainfall, 210 frost-free days and bright sunshine for its growth. Jute is known as the **golden fiber**, it grows well on well-drained fertile soils in the flood plains.

4. Technological and Institutional Reforms

• **Institutional Reforms:** Collectivisation, consolidation of holdings, cooperation and abolition of zamindari were given priority after Independence. Land reform was the main focus of our First Five Year Plan.
• **Technological Reforms:** The Green Revolution (based on package technology) and the White Revolution (Operation Flood) were initiated to improve Indian agriculture.
• **Financial & Support Reforms:** Provision for crop insurance against drought, flood, cyclone, fire and disease. Establishment of Grameen banks, cooperative societies and banks for providing loan facilities to the farmers at lower rates of interest. Introduction of **Kisan Credit Card (KCC)** and Personal Accident Insurance Scheme (PAIS). Announcement of Minimum Support Price (MSP) to check exploitation of farmers by speculators.